

## INTERMEDIATE GRAMMAR

**Directions for questions 1 and 2:** In each of the following sentences, a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

Mali is one of those countries which almost nobody, except its hapless inhabitants, more worries about, until disaster suddenly looms, threatening to spread poison beyond its borders.

☐ a) who almost nobody, except its hapless inhabitants, much worries about

☒ b) which almost nobody, except its hapless inhabitants, much worries about (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) which almost nobody, except its hapless inhabitants, much worry about

☐ d) which almost nobody, except its hapless inhabitants, more worry about

**Directions for questions 1 and 2:** In each of the following sentences, a part of the sentence is underlined. Beneath each sentence, four different ways of phrasing the underlined part are indicated. Choose the best alternative and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

As the dominant power in South Asia and one of the leading democracy., India must find a proper answer to what can otherwise become a serious existential crisis of monumental proportions.

☐ a) and one of the leading democracy, India must find a proper answer to what can otherwise become a serious existential crisis

☐ b) and one of the leading democracies, India must find a proper answer to what can otherwise become a serious existential crises

☐ c) and one of the leading democracies, India must find a proper answer to what could become a serious existential crisis otherwise

☒ d) and one of the leading democracies, India must find a proper answer to what could otherwise become a serious existential crisis (Your answer - ✓)

**Directions for questions 3 to 7:** In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- (a) Malaysia offers an enticing lifestyle and culture.
- (b) The country is made of a multicultural society that is harmonious, friendly and welcoming.
- (c) From vibrant cities with a thriving nightlife to its rich and beautiful natural landscape, the chance to enjoy a varied way of life is accessible easily.
- (d) Together with affordable amenities like transport, schools and healthcare, Malaysia offers a high quality lifestyle
- (e) with an excellent work-life balance that has continued to attract people from all round the world.

☒ a) a and e (Your answer - ✓)

- ☐ b) b, c and d
- ☐ c) a, b and d
- ☐ d) a, b, and e

**Directions for questions 3 to 7:** In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

(a) Scurvy, a disease historically associated with old-world sailors is making a surprise comeback in Australia,

( b) with health officials revealing a rare spate of cases.

(c) Caused by vitamin C deficiency, the condition used to be a common – and often fatal - curse in seafarers

(d) who went without fresh fruits and vegetables for months.

(e) Once barely heard of in developed countries, reports suggest the problem is also on the rise in Britain.

☐ a) a, d and e

☐ b) b, d and e

☒ c) a and c (Your answer - ✕)

☐ d) c and e

### Solution:

In a, the words "a disease historically associated with old-world sailors" provides additional information to the sentence. Such an expression is called a parenthetical expression.

A parenthetical expression should begin and end with a comma. Hence a comma should be inserted at the end of the word "sailors" to denote the end of the parentheses. In c, the preposition "in" should be replaced by "among" because when the reference is to something happening in groups, "among" is the correct preposition to be used. b, d and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (B)

**Directions for questions 3 to 7:** In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

(a) Researchers have found that astronauts experience blurry vision and impaired eyesight after long space flights due to changes in spinal fluid that occurs while in microgravity.

(b) Nearly two-third of astronauts have reported problems with their eyes after spending months at the International Space Station

(c) according to research presented at the annual meeting of the Radiological Society of North America.

(d) According to the researchers at University of Miami Miller School of Medicine, some of the astronauts

(e) had severe structural changes, that were not fully reversible, upon return to earth.

☐ a) c and d

☐ b) b and e

☒ c) c and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ d) Only b

(a) One need only drive 30km west from the bustling heart of Nanjing – population about 7m – to reach the shady sanctaury of the Laoshan National Forest Park.

(b) But on a recent sparkling autumn afternoon only a trickle of visitors had come to enjoy the abundant birdsong, the scent of pines and the rustling of falling ginkgo leaves.

(c) Unlike many of China's wilderness attractions, Laoshan had eschewed the hurly-burly of market stalls and other facilities intended to cater to a crush of tourists.

(d) There are simple wooden steps installed here and there, but no concrete staircases, iron railings or trails

(e) festooned in coloured pennants and loudspeakers playing soppy music.

☐ a) c, d and e

☒ b) d and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) b, c and d

☐ d) b and d

### Solution:

In a, the word "sanctuary" is wrongly spelt. In b, the verb form "rustling" is inappropriate. The noun "rustle" is appropriate here, in order to maintain parallelism with the preceding noun clauses "...birdsong", "...scent of pines". Hence, "...rustle of ginkgo leaves" is the correction here. In c, the past tense "had eschewed" is incorrect because the reference is to a past action which is still relevant. Hence the present perfect tense "has eschewed" is appropriate here. Only d and e are grammatically correct.  
Choice (B)

- (a) In the mid-19<sup>th</sup> century, hundreds of thousands of Americans flocked west in search of gold.
- (b) Today those with an appetite for treasure head for Rocky Mountains, where Forrest Fenn, an octogenarian art collector,
- (c) claims to have hidden a bronze box containing gold coins, Chinese jade, emerald jewellery and other riches, including two gold nuggets “as large as chicken eggs”.
- (d) Mr. Fenn had the idea to stash the treasure nearly 30 years ago
- (e) when he was diagnosed with aggressive kidney cancer and told his chances were slim.

☐ a) a and e

☒ b) a, c and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) d and e

☐ d) b and d

### Solution:

In b, the word “head” should be followed by the preposition “to”. One heads to a particular place and not for. In d, the word “stash” should be followed by “away”. To stash away something is to store something in a safe or secret place. Hence, b and d are erroneous and the remaining sentences are free of errors.

Choice (B)

(a) As digitalization and the web take over our everyday life, exposure to the world has brought in the need to bring it into our schools.

(b) So now the world rests in every classroom as international schooling is fast gaining ground.

(c) Catering to a global economy, the Indian education has also experienced a great shift.

(d) No longer rote learning is the need of the hour, practical and theory need to mingle with awareness and activities.

(e) Schools now provide a curriculum suited to the overall individual growth.

☐ a) a, b and c

☐ b) a, c and e

☒ c) b, c and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ d) a and e

### Solution:

In a, the word "life" should be in the plural because the reference is to several lives.  
In statement d, the ordering of words is incorrect. The correction is "No longer is rote learning the need of the hour".  
Statements b, c and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (C)

(a) A Japanese study published in the Journal of International Medicine that reviewed 39 previous studies, find that people who follow a vegetarian diet tend to have a lower blood pressure compared to meat eaters.

(b) A plant-based diet is typically low in fat and sodium and higher in fibre and potassium, all of which can help maintain a healthy blood pressure.

(c) Another study in the Journal of Investigative Dermatology suggests that exposure to sunlight may help lower blood pressure.

(d) Exposure to sunlight increases nitric oxide in the blood, widens the blood vessels and lowers blood pressure.

(e) Although avoiding exposure to excess sunlight is critical to prevent skin cancer, but not being exposed to it at all could increase the risk of cardiovascular diseases.

☐ a) a, d and e

☐ b) c and e

☐ c) d and e

☐ d) c, d and e (Correct Answer - ✓)



- (a) In the cat- and- mouse chase between the law enforcer and terrorist, the freelance radical poses a serious policing challenge.
- (b) In many ways, this new terror species are an effective option for terror operators for terror to do the job from a distance, escaping notice while making an equal impact with less risk.
- (c) This is important for the merchants of terror, who find it difficult to operate in an environment where every country is working to rise the cost of carrying out a terror attack by setting up specialized forces backed by strong, arguably intrusive, anti- terror laws.
- (d) Evidently, the battle with free-lance radicals and self-made terrorists has only just begun.
- (e) Beside tracking and countering threats from outside the country, the government also needs to look within and come up with a comprehensive strategy to tackle and eliminate the problem.

☐ a) a and d

☒ b) Only a (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) a, d and e

☐ d) c and d

### Solution:

In statement b, the word "species" should be followed by the singular verb "is", because the reference, here, is to one single species of terror – the freelance radical. In c, the verb "rise", meaning, which suggests a movement upwards or an increase in the amount or quantity, does not make sense. The verb "raise", meaning to lift something to a higher position or increase it, is appropriate here. In d, the preposition "against" should be used in the place of "with" because the reference is to a fight against free-lance radicals and terrorists. In statement e, the preposition "beside", meaning next to or adjacent to does not make sense. "Besides", meaning in addition to is the correct preposition here. Hence, except statement a, all the other statements are grammatically incorrect.

Choice (B)

- (a) Economic mismanagement, corruption, inflation and declining growth rates have affected India's national security adversely and its ability to conduct an effective foreign policy.
- (b) Financial profligacy has resulted in a drastic fall in the country's defence budget to less than 1.75 per cent of GDP – the lowest level in over half a century.
- (c) The armed forces are woefully short of crucial weapons and equipment, including fighter aircrafts, submarines and mountain artillery, to meet security challenges across our land and maritime borders.
- (d) Moreover, efforts to build an industrial base to meet our growing defence needs have not gathered momentum.
- (e) Our influence with neighbours is declining as funds for economic assistance to them are being pruned.

☐ a) b, d and e (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ b) d and e
- ☐ c) b and c
- ☐ d) c, d and e

### Solution:

In a, the adverb "adversely" is inappropriately placed. Here, the adverb is modifying the verb "affected", hence it should be placed before it. Therefore, the correction is "....have adversely affected...". In c, the use of the word "aircraft" in the plural is incorrect. The word "aircraft" does not have a plural form. Statements b, d and e are error free.  
Choice (A)

**Directions for questions 12 to 15:** Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- (a ) The lives of the people in the villages near the India-Pakistan border and the line of control in Jammu and Kashmir are intertwined to the security forces, deployed there, especially the army.
- (b) The government almost entirely relies on the Army to function in the border areas.
- (c) Even infrastructure investment in the border areas is done through the army and the local population benefits from it.
- (d) The army is the biggest employer in the border areas.

☐ a) a and c

☒ b) Only a (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) c and d

☐ d) b and c

**Solution:**

In statement a, the word "intertwined" should be followed by the preposition "with", something is intertwined with something and not to something.

Choice (B)

**Directions for questions 12 to 15:** Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- (a) Sarnath, close to Varanasi, is the place where Buddha preached his first sermon.
- (b) In the 3<sup>rd</sup> century BC, the Mauryan emperor Ashoka caused several stupas and monasteries to be constructed in this place, to commemorate the event.
- (c) The highlight for travellers to Sarnath is undoubtedly the cylindrical Dhamekh Stupa, mounted on a circular base that is carved with intricate geometrical and floral patterns.
- (d) Perhaps more recognisably, the famous column topped by four lions facing the cardinal directions – which is the inspiration to India's official emblem – is preserved in the Sarnath Archaeological Museum.

☐ a) c and d

☒ b) a and d (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) b and d

☐ d) Only d

**Solution:**

The word "Buddha", meaning the enlightened one, should be preceded by the definite article because the reference is to a particular title. In d, the word "inspiration" should be followed by the preposition "for" because something serves as an inspiration for something and not to. Hence statements a and d are erroneous.

Choice (B)

**Directions for questions 12 to 15:** Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- (a) The conventional practise of just assessing employee performance as a measure of an organization's success is long gone.
- (b) This is the new age of employee engagement – creating an ambiance enabling employees to feel a sense of belonging and be part of the organization's journey towards it's vision.
- (c) Organizations have realized that inspired employees who contribute the most are the strongest drivers of success.
- (d) Employee performance is hence tied integrally to how effectively organizations engage and stimulate the positive vibes in their most competitive employees.

- ☐ a) a and c
- ☐ b) a, b and c
- ☐ c) a, c and d
- ☐ d) a, b and d

**Solution:**

The use of the verb "practise" instead of the noun "practice" makes statement a incorrect. In b, the expression "it's", meaning it is incorrect. The pronoun "its" should be used here in order to make the sentence grammatically correct. In statement d, the word "engage" should be followed by the preposition "with". Only statement c is error free.

Choice (D)

**Directions for questions 12 to 15:** Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

(a) Skill gap is a reality for companies over various sectors in India.

(b) Around 30 lakh graduates join the job market every year but only about 5 lakh of them are considered employable.

(c) According to National Skill Development Corporation, the growing skill gap in India will be more than 25 crore workers by 2022.

(d) Skill gap is felt acutely by companies in the Indian manufacturing sector, as they are unable to find qualified candidates for open positions.

- ☐ a) a, and d
- ☐ b) b and d
- ☐ c) Only c
- ☐ d) a, b and d

**Solution:**

In a, the use of the preposition "over" is incorrect. The preposition "across" is more appropriate here because the reference is to every part of a place. In d, the positioning of the adverb "acutely" is incorrect. The adverb should precede the verb, felt, which it is modifying in this sentence. Therefore, the correction is "Skill gap is acutely felt....". Therefore, statements a and d are erroneous.

Choice (A)